Digital Marketing

Lecture 1, Class 1: An Introduction to Digital Marketing

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Icebreaker: You Already Do This!

"Raise your hand if you bought something online this week."

"Now — who researched a product online before buying it in a store?"

Key Insight

You just experienced digital marketing — whether you realized it or not.

Every time you scroll social media, search on Google, or open a promo email — that IS digital marketing.

What is Digital Marketing?

Promoting products or services using digital channels — search engines, social media, email, websites, and mobile apps.

Academic View:

Digital marketing uses digital technologies to connect with consumers, build brand awareness, and drive measurable results — moving from one-way broadcasting to two-way conversations.

Example

Think of a burger shop in Dhanmondi posting a mouth-watering burger photo on Facebook with 'Order Now' button. That single post is search, social, and mobile marketing working together.

Why is Digital Marketing VITAL?

Sl.	Reason	Why It Matters
1	Global Reach	A small shop in Dhaka can sell to a buyer in New York
2	Cost-Effective	Higher ROI than TV/print — fits any budget
3	Targeted	Show ads only to the right age, location, interests
4	Measurable	Every click, view, purchase tracked in real-time
5	24/7 Presence	Your shop never sleeps — customers find you anytime
6	Personalization	"Hi Rafi, we thought you'd like this!"

Traditional Marketing

Any promotion used for decades before the internet: TV, Radio, Newspapers, Billboards, Direct Mail, Telemarketing

Pros ✓	Cons ✗
Tangible and credible	Expensive to produce and run
Works well for local audiences	Hard to measure exact ROI
Strong with older demographics	One-way — no interaction
Physical presence in public	Long time to create and launch

Example: A Grameenphone billboard on a Dhaka highway — everyone driving by sees it, but no one can click it.

Digital Marketing

Marketing that uses an electronic device or the internet to connect with customers: SEO, Social Media, Email, PPC, Content

Pros ✓	Cons ✗
Cost-effective and scalable	Highly competitive, saturated
Easy to measure and analyze	Algorithm changes hurt visibility
Highly targeted by interest/age	Privacy rules limit targeting
Two-way interaction & real-time tweaks	Ad fatigue — users tune out ads

Example: That same Grameenphone billboard becomes a Facebook ad — viewers can click 'Buy Now' instantly and GP can see exactly who clicked.

Traditional vs Digital: Quick Comparison

Aspect	Traditional	Digital
Medium	TV, Radio, Print, Billboards	Social, Search, Email, Websites
Communication	One-way (broadcast)	Two-way (interactive)
Cost	Expensive	Flexible & affordable
Audience	Broad / mass	Hyper-targeted
Measurability	Hard to track	Trackable in real-time
Engagement	Passive	Active — likes, shares, comments

Key Insight: Smart marketers combine both — a billboard can drive people to a website!

The 7 C's of Digital Marketing

C	Meaning	Simple Example
Customer	Understand & meet their needs	Start with a buyer persona, not the product
Content	Create valuable, relevant material	A skincare brand's 'how to' videos
Context	Right message, right place, time	Show umbrella ads on rainy days
Community	Build a loyal following	A Facebook group of loyal fans
Convenience	Easy access and usability	One-click mobile checkout
Cohesion	One consistent brand message	Same tone on Facebook, Insta, website
Conversion	Turn visitors into paying customers	A clear 'Buy Now' button

The 5 A's: Customer Journey

A	Meaning	What Marketers Do
Aware	Customer knows you exist	SEO, social ads, PR for visibility
Appeal	Customer finds you interesting	Compelling, resonant content
Ask	Customer researches you	Reviews, FAQs, easy-to-find info
Act	Customer buys or signs up	Smooth checkout, less friction
Advocate	Customer recommends you	Referral programs, loyalty rewards

Not always a straight line! A customer may go Aware → Ask → Appeal → Act. Advocacy loops back to attract new customers.

Putting It Together: Real-Life Walkthrough

Example: Buying shoes online from a Bangladeshi brand

Aware — You see a shoe ad on Facebook (Content + Context)

Appeal — The design and price catch your eye (Content)

Ask — You check reviews and their Instagram page (Community)

Act — You order with one-click checkout (Convenience + Conversion)

Advocate — You post an unboxing story and tag the brand (Community)

Keywords in Digital Marketing?

Trend	In Simple Words	Why It Matters
AI in Marketing	Chatbots, personalized picks	Automates tasks, scales personalization
Short-Form Video	Reels, Shorts, TikTok	Matches shrinking attention spans
Social Commerce	Buy inside Instagram/FB/TikTok	Fewer clicks to purchase
Influencer Marketing	Micro-influencers, niche experts	More trust than celebrities
Voice Search	Optimizing for 'Hey Google'	50%+ of searches are now voice

Challenges: The Reality Check

High Competition — everyone is online, standing out is hard

Ad Fatigue — users are overwhelmed and ignore generic ads

Privacy Regulations — GDPR, CCPA and a cookie-less future make targeting harder

Algorithm Changes — platforms change rules overnight, cutting organic reach

Content Overload — huge volume of content makes attention scarce